StudyTree

AI TUTORING FOR TEXTBOOKS & LECTURE SLIDES

Every question about a textbook, organised as a tree on the page it's about.

Highlight a passage or box a diagram, ask, branch, and pin the answers back onto the page. Every learner leaves with a study map instead of a lost chat scroll.

Live demo: ghubliming.github.io/StudyTree

Investor deck · [Month Year]

THE PROBLEM

AI chat made reading *easier* to ask about, and *harder* to learn from.

- **Answers live in a side panel**, disconnected from the sentence or figure they explain.
- **One long linear scroll.** Every follow-up, tangent and retry piles up; good explanations get buried.
- **Exploring alternatives destroys context.** “Explain it simpler” and “give an example” compete for the same thread.
- **Nothing goes back into the book.** The PDF you revise from has none of what you learned.

What research on reading tools says

A 2025 study of AI margin notes argues that comments tied to specific text beat chat in a separate side panel, because the side panel disconnects the discussion from its context.

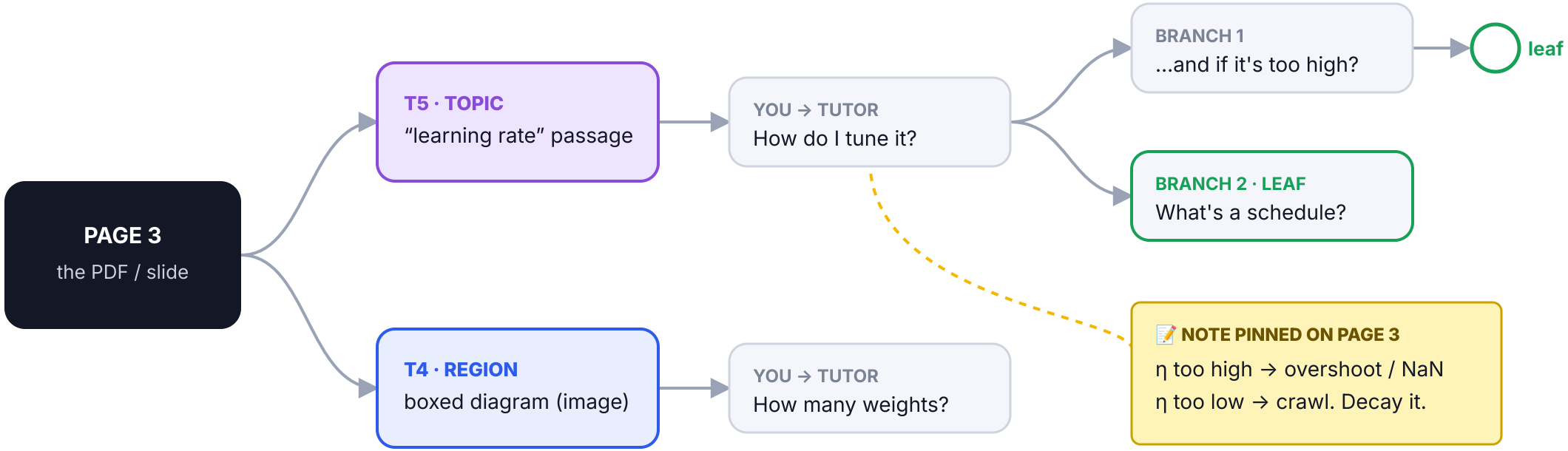
HCI work in 2026 (Branchat, CanvasConvo, Conversation Tree Architecture) shows learners need **branching**, revisitable conversations, but these are research prototypes, not reading products.

Sources: arXiv 2509.09840 (AI margin notes in document readers); ACM 10.1145/3772363.3798792 (Branchat); arXiv 2605.15848 (CanvasConvo); arXiv 2603.21278 (Conversation Tree Architecture).

THE SOLUTION

A study tree that lives on the page.

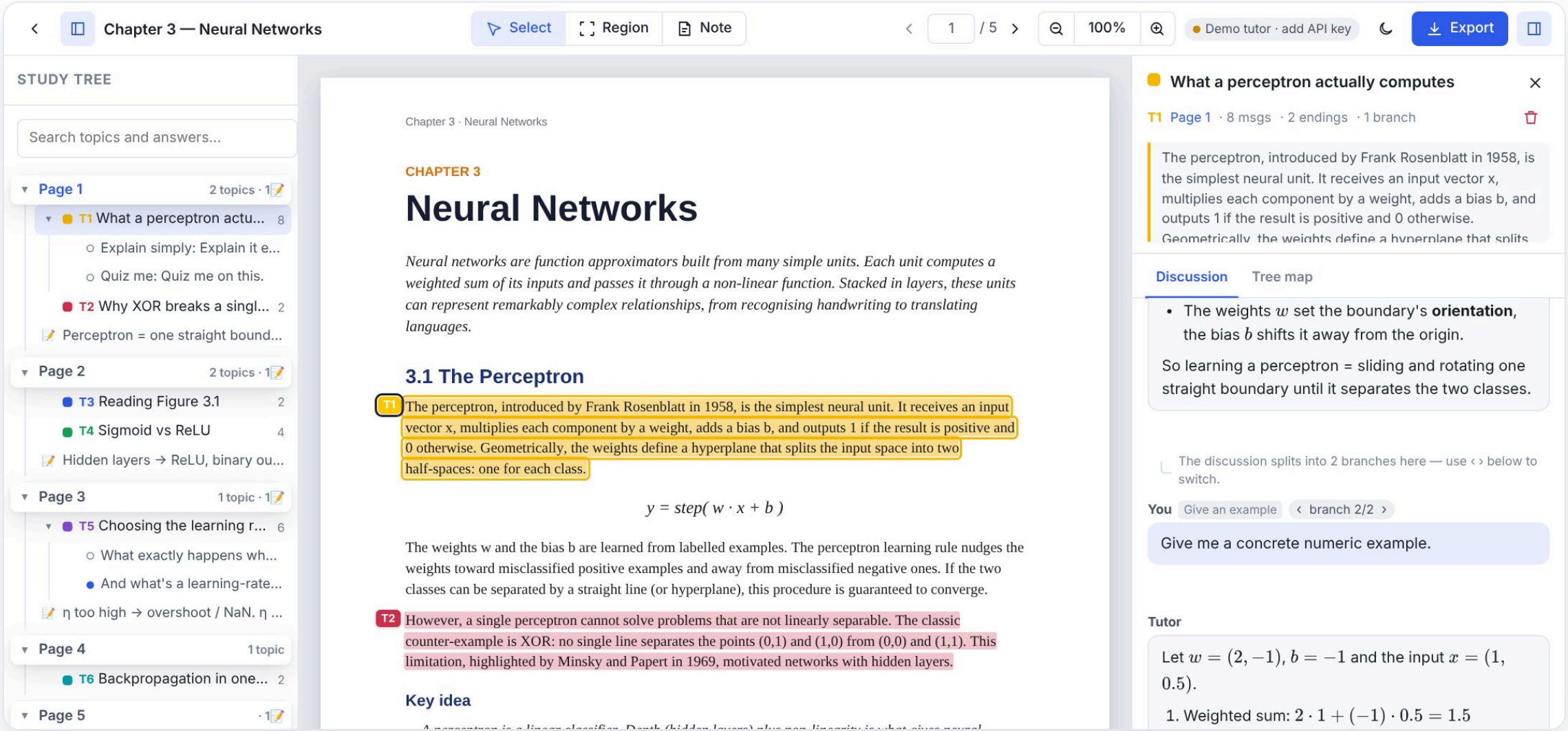
Each page holds topics. Each topic holds a discussion that can branch, and every branch ends in a leaf. The best answers become notes pinned exactly where they belong.



Main = the page · Topic = what you asked about · Sub = the discussion · Leaves = where each line of thought ended

THE PRODUCT

Outline · page · discussion: one screen.

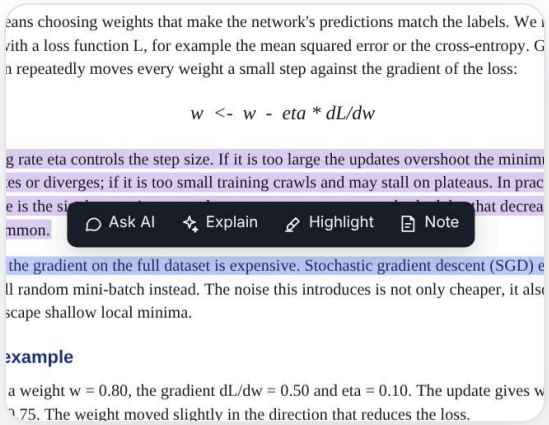


Left: the study tree (page → topic → thread endings). **Centre:** highlights, T-badges and a pinned note on the page. **Right:** the discussion, with “branch 2/2” switching.

HOW IT WORKS

Four moves, zero lost context.

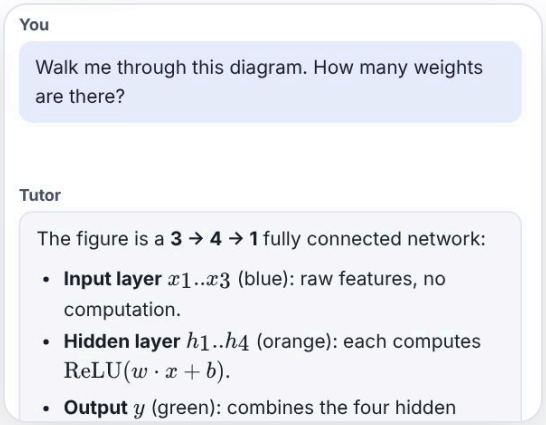
1



Select or box

Highlight text, or box a diagram, formula or table. The tutor sees the page, its neighbours and the image.

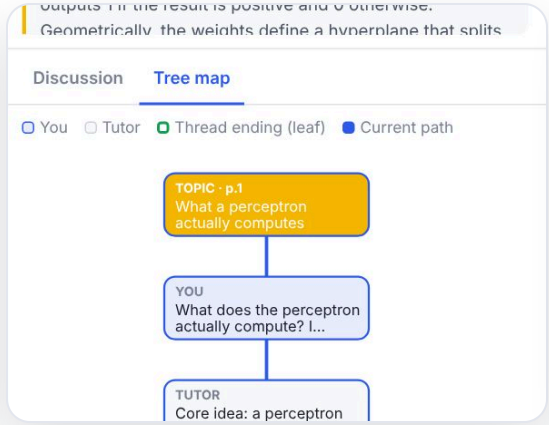
2



Ask in context

Grounded, streamed answers with maths. Quick actions: explain simply, example, quiz me, key terms.

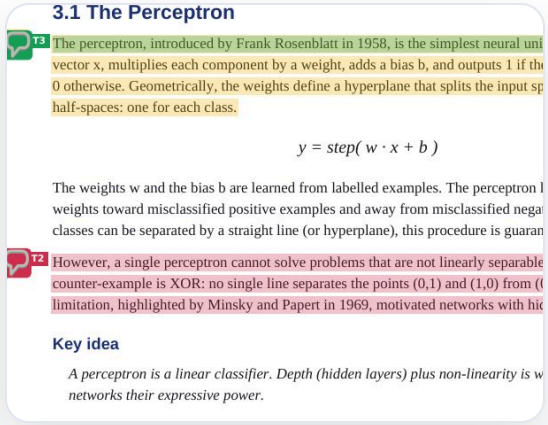
3



Branch freely

Retry, edit or “branch here” forks the thread instead of overwriting it. The tree map shows every path.

4



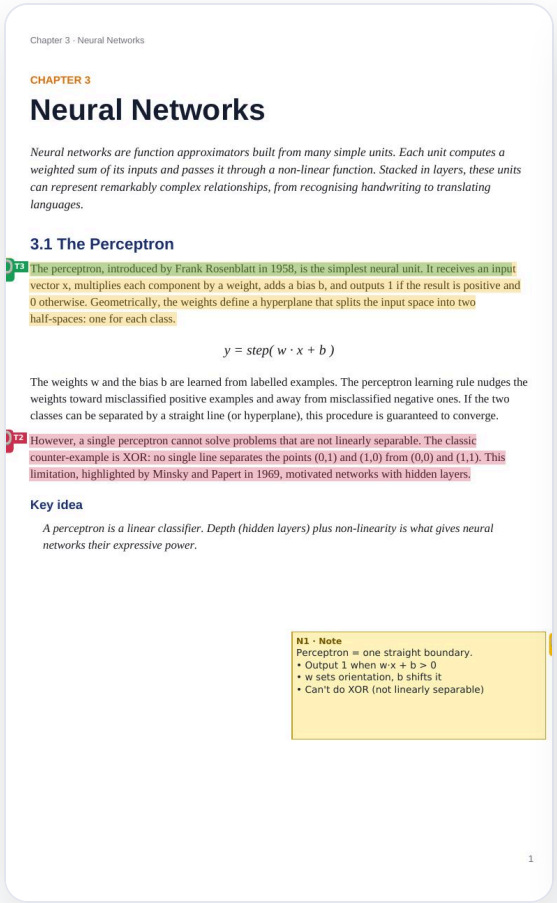
Pin & keep

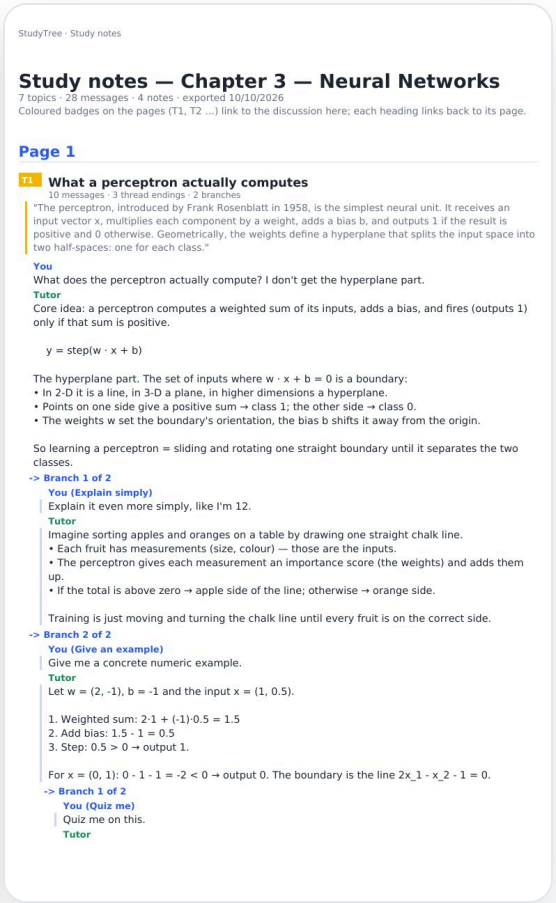
Pin answers as notes on the page, then export an annotated PDF that carries the whole session.

Works with PDF textbooks and PPT/PPTX/Keynote/Word (converted on the server).

THE LEARNING STAYS WITH THE DOCUMENT

Export that a PDF can actually hold.





- **Annotated PDF** for any reader: highlights, T-badges, note boxes, real PDF comments.
- **Study-notes appendix** with every discussion and branch; badges link in, headings link back.
- **Session embedded inside the PDF:** drop it back into StudyTree and every topic, branch and note returns.
- **Lossless `.studytree` pack** (original + full tree) and Markdown for Notion or Obsidian.

A shared PDF is also a distribution channel: every recipient can re-open the session in StudyTree.

WHY NOW

The model got good. The interface didn't.

Models can tutor

Current LLMs read a page, follow a highlighted passage and explain diagrams from an image of them. Grounded tutoring is now a UI problem, not a model problem.

Chat-with-PDF is commoditised

Adobe, NotebookLM and many “chat with your PDF” tools offer Q&A with citations. Answering is table stakes; **organising and keeping** what was learned is open.

Research points the way

2025–26 HCI papers show anchored notes and branching conversation trees help readers, but no reading product ships them together yet.

See competition slide for products reviewed and sources.

MARKET

Hundreds of millions of learners read from PDFs and slides.

269M

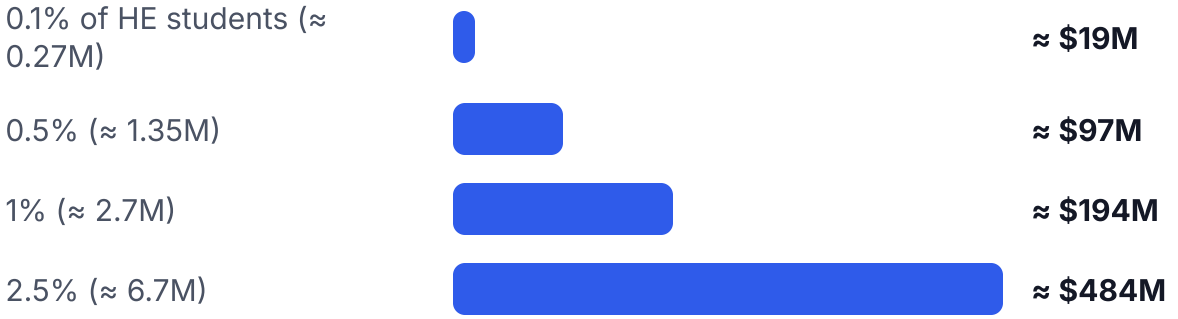
students in higher education worldwide (2024), up from ~100M in 2000. UNESCO

$5.8B – $48.6B

range of 2030 forecasts for the "AI in education" market; analysts define the market very differently. MarketsandMarkets; Research and Markets

Illustrative bottom-up (assumption, not a forecast)

Annual revenue = paying students × $6 / month × 12



Excludes institutional licences, K-12, professional certification and corporate training, all adjacent segments that use the same workflow.

UNESCO Higher Education Global Trends Report (May 2026), via thepienews.com · MarketsandMarkets "AI in Education" (Aug 2025): $5.82B by 2030 · Research and Markets (Feb 2025): $48.6B by 2030.

COMPETITION

Others answer questions. We organise the learning.

	AI Q&A grounded in the document	Answers anchored to the passage	Branching discussion tree	Notes pinned on the page	PDF export that keeps the discussions
Chat-with-PDF tools Adobe AI Assistant, ChatPDF and similar	✓	~	—	—	—
NotebookLM Google	✓	~	—	—	—
Glasp PDF chat highlights + chat	✓	~	—	~	—
LiquidText, MarginNote annotation-first readers	~	—	—	✓	~
Branchat, CanvasConvo research prototypes, no document	—	—	✓	—	—
StudyTree	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

✓ core feature · ~ partial (e.g. citations or highlights as context) · — not found on public product pages or forums reviewed in Oct 2026; may change. Sources: adobe.com/acrobat/online/ai-chat-pdf · glasp.co/pdf-chat · LiquidText & MarginNote App Store pages and user forums · ACM 10.1145/3772363.3798792 · arXiv 2605.15848.

BUSINESS MODEL PROPOSED · TO VALIDATE IN PILOTS

Freemium for students, licences for institutions.

Free

$0

- Unlimited documents, topics, branches, notes
- Limited AI answers per month
- All exports

Student Pro

[$X] / month

- Generous AI answers, best model
- Region / diagram questions
- Sync across devices
- Exam-prep: quizzes from your tree

Institution

per seat / year

- Instructor-shared course packs
- LMS integration, SSO
- Data stays in-region; local-first by design
- Learning analytics on where students get stuck

AI cost scales with usage; tree-scoped context (one page + one topic) keeps each request small.

GO-TO-MARKET

Course by course, PDF by PDF.

1 · Courses with heavy readings

Start in university STEM and law courses where students live in PDFs and slide decks. Instructors seed a course pack with pinned explanations.

2 · Built-in sharing loop

Every exported PDF carries its session. A classmate who receives it can open the full study tree in StudyTree, so the product travels with the document.

3 · Land and expand

Student adoption in a department gives proof for a paid institutional licence: SSO, LMS integration and analytics.

Pilot plan: [N] courses at [institutions] over [term]. Measure weekly active learners, topics per student, notes pinned, export/share rate and exam-prep usage.

WHERE WE ARE

A working product, live today.

Shipped (MVP)

- PDF + PPT/PPTX/Word import
- Text and region (image) questions
- Branching threads, outline, tree map
- Notes on the page
- Annotated PDF, study pack, Markdown
- Claude-powered tutor; offline demo mode
- Public demo on GitHub Pages; Docker; CI

Next 6 months

- Accounts and cloud sync
- Shared course packs for instructors
- Quiz / spaced repetition from the tree
- OCR for scanned books; CJK fonts in export
- Pilots with [N] courses

12 months +

- LMS integrations (Canvas, Moodle) and SSO
- Instructor analytics: where the class gets stuck
- Mobile and tablet with pen input
- Institutional licences

Traction: [users / pilots / waitlist, add when available]

TEAM

Who is building this.

[Founder name]

[Role, e.g. CEO]

[Relevant background: education, product, domain]

[Co-founder name]

[Role, e.g. CTO]

[Relevant background]

Advisors

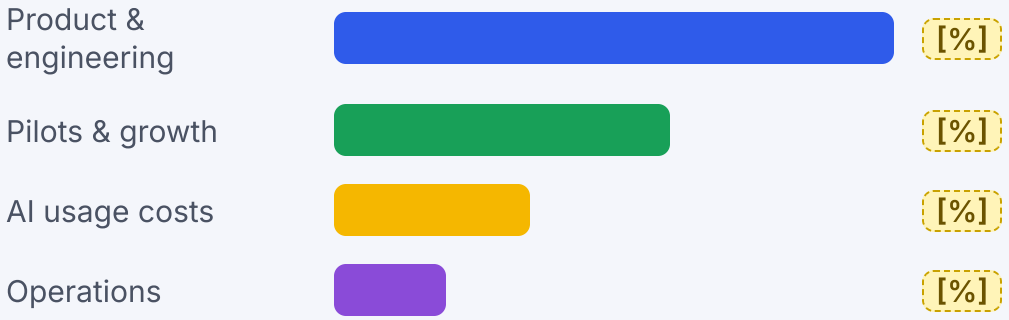
[Educators / EdTech operators]

Yellow fields are placeholders. Fill them in before sharing this deck.

THE ASK

Raising [$ amount] [pre-seed / seed].

Use of funds (example split, adjust)



Milestones this round buys

- Accounts, sync and course sharing in production
- Pilots in [N] courses with measured retention
- First institutional licence(s)
- [Target] monthly active learners

StudyTree

Try it now.

ghubliming.github.io/StudyTree

Open the sample chapter: six topics, branching discussions and pinned notes are ready to explore. Select any sentence and ask.

[name@email.com] · [phone / LinkedIn]